
Selections from
the
Note-Books
of
Gerard Manley Hopkins

THE POETS OF THE YEAR



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EDITED BY T. WEISS

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NEW DIRECTIONS

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The Apprenticeship of Gerard Manley Hopkins

THERE is a continuity in the workbooks of Gerard Manley Hopkins that might elude the casual reader. From a notation (April, 1864) among the first entries in his *Early Diaries*, and first in this selection, we discover Hopkins' remarking "no royal road to poetry." Paradoxically then he comments: "The world should know by this time that one cannot reach Parnassus except by flying thither." The paradox disappears, however, and the continuity emerges: the following extracts show what lessons in humility, patience, and self-effacement poetry meant to him: how pedestrian the flight must be; for only then the senses and the mind and heart can fly.

Studying his descriptions, raw material for eventual poems, we come at last to our closing statement (August, 1880), princely paradox again after our recognition of his objectivity; here Hopkins states his belief in the supremacy, the inviolability of his selfhood. "I find myself . . . more important to myself than anything I see." The rest of the world served as his clothes, "derivative" of this self. So speaking of the wind, "when I came out I seemed to put it on like a gown as a man puts on the shadow he walks into and hoods or hats himself with the shelter of a roof, a penthouse, or a copse of trees."

Typical was his tendency to see the world in terms of the human body and its properties; the limbs of Orpheus scattered everywhere, only a devotion like Hopkins' could combine them, breathe life and song into them again. For though it is himself Hopkins sees, what a mightily comprehensive self it is. All the earth unfurls in the fling of his arms and his glances. Not only did his egoism become all-embracing (only such a passionate personality could achieve such intense detachment), but this egoism nearly established its oneness with the world. Such docility and ductability, such reining of self before the earth, meant an absorption of rather than a passing through what the *I* sees, houses, and humanises. Even here in these excerpts, as in great poems, the poet is dissolved in his own identity. Such strenuous seeing as these observations everywhere betray only joy and strength deserve.

In his devotion to his surroundings, Hopkins' painting and etching skill served him admirably; we see the accuracy that is passion, that only passion can attain. So he brought the same precision to bear on dreams, fairytales, folklore, idioms or expressions, architecture, clouds, ducks, rivers, musical instruments, gems, and peacocks. Filled with the artist's regret at losing even inconspicuous splendor, the "bye-ways beauty," he again and again exercised the Faustian "Stay!" of words. What terrible patience of eye, sought out by the quieter faces of ecstasy, meets us on all sides. It is the eye and the ear writing. One comes to expect his breathless spurrings of phrase, his diamond-edged diction: "sleepy mealy haze" or

the color "searching" or the tree "flung of its leaves."

We need barely pause to discover his observations' kinship with the genre painters who domesticated what they saw with a Dutch meticulousness of mellow light. Nor need we stress his work's relation to Emily Dickinson and the imagists with their desire for immaculate looking. He knew that "what you look hard at seems to look hard at you." But the rarity of his pointed patience and unblinking application finds freshest remembrance in such precisionists as Marianne Moore, Wallace Stevens, and William Carlos Williams.

Hopkins' meticulousness properly expressed itself in terms of his daily world. His affection, Dutch-like, for domestic furniture and the features of the body everywhere asserts itself. Everywhere rain or rocks, sea or snow toes the earth. Eyelids and veins, brows and fingers, man is the scrupulous measure of Hopkins' world. So too, kitchen talk computes his sight: coffee, soapsuds, cream, sopped cake, cocoa, starch, ginger syrup. He, however, brings this indoors out into the most vigorous open world. In his awareness of the drama of the inanimate, nothing of the stuffy, finicky, dimity oppresses his descriptions.

Unfortunately, as the scant population in his poetry admits, Hopkins boggled at people. His letters and several of his poems confess his love for human beings. But this love, by its very power, awoke his suspicion. So he refused feelings he with few equals was capable of. Knowing the inebriation of the senses, he recoiled and sought refuge from them. Fearing people apparently as temptations, he tried to sup-

press them in himself. But they were not to be dammed. They sluiced through him, as his language proves, into every secret corner of the world his clairvoyance illuminated. In each object he remarked its personality or what he called "inscape" or "in-stress," that principle which determines the definition of an object, its quality ("thingness") and distinction from all other objects. This "in-shape" or inner shape is wholly one with the shape it produces. Like the energies his cassock muted, this humanity in him must, charged with grandeur a god might respect, burst forth in turmoiled lines. Only such strength as his could destroy this strength; the grinding within him of energies ignored finally tore him apart. Religion seems to have become for him the rock that balked his senses and impaled him. It crushed his otherwise inviolable integrity, something his literary conscience had allowed no other experience to do. For him religion was the experience that denied all others, even himself. As Rimbaud put it: "Christ: eternal thief of energies."

Hopkins already anticipated what has increasingly become the pattern for the ablest men of letters, all the way from André Gide to Henry Miller, priests of literature, all bound by a consecration to what they do and see. Hopkins could not break free short of death, could not realise that devotion to art, especially one as responsible and piercing as his, might be life, service, and sanctity enough. The following extracts should afford ample testimony thereto.

T. WEISS

From the Note-Books of Gerard Manley Hopkins

IT is a happy thing that there is no royal road to poetry. The world should know by this time that one cannot reach Parnassus except by flying thither. Yet from time to time more men go up and either perish in its gullies fluttering *excelsior* flags or else come down again with full folios and blank countenances. Yet the old fallacy keeps its ground. Every age has its false alarms.



MOONLIGHT hanging or dropping on treetops like blue cobweb.



Also the upper sides of little grotted waves turned to the sky have soft pale-coloured cobwebs on them, the under sides green.



NOTE that the beaded oar, dripping, powders or sows the smooth with dry silver drops.



THE sky minted into golden sequins.
Stars like gold tufts.

—— ——— golden bees.

—— ——— golden rowels.



DROPS of rain hanging on rails etc. seen with only the lower rim lighted like nails (of fingers). Screws of brooks and twines. Soft chalky look with more shadowy middles of the globes of cloud on a night with a moon faint or concealed. Mealy clouds with a not brilliant moon. Blunt buds of the ash. Pencil buds of the beech. Lobes of the trees. Cups of the eyes, Gathering back the lightly hinged eyelids. Bows of the eyelids. Pencil of eyelashes. Juices of the eyeball. Eyelids like leaves, petals, caps, tufted hats, handkerchiefs, sleeves, gloves. Also of the bones sleeved in flesh. Juices of the sunrise. Joins and veins of the same. Vermilion look of the hand held against a candle with the darker parts as the middles of the fingers and especially the knuckles covered with ash.



IN one place over a smooth table of rock came slipping down a blade of water looking like and as evenly crisped as fruitnets let drop and falling slack.

We saw Handeck waterfall. It is in fact the meeting of two waters, the right the Aar sallow and jade-coloured, the left a smaller stream of clear lilac foam. It is the greatest fall we have seen. The lower half is hidden in spray. I watched the great bushes of foam-water, the texture of branchings and water-spandrils which makes them up. At their outsides nearest the rock they gave off showers of drops strung together into little quills which sprang out in fans.

On crossing the Aar again there was as good a fall as some we have paid to see, all in jostling foam-bags.

Across the valley too we saw the fall of the Gelmer

—like milk chasing round blocks of coal; or a girdle or long purse of white weighted with irregular black rubies, carelessly thrown aside and lying in jutting bends, with a black clasp of the same stone at the top—for those were the biggest blocks, squared, and built up, as it happened, in lessening stories, and the cascade enclosed them on the right and left hand with its foam; or once more like the skin of a white snake square-pied with black.



ABOVE the Breithorn Antares sparkled like a bright crabapple tingling in the wind.



THE valley is beautiful. The mountains bounding it give one more the impression of height than I have seen in any other valley.—I was noticing on each side of a buttress of rock two fan-shaped slant tables of green, flush with one another and laced over with a *plant* or root-work of zigzag brooks ravelled out and shining.



WE passed a gorge at the end of which it was curious to see a tree rubbing and ruffling with the water at the neck just above a fall.—Then we saw a grotto, that is deep and partly covered chambers of rock through which the torrent river runs.—A little beyond, I think, was a wayside chapel with a woman kneeling at a window a long time.—Further, across the valley a pretty village, the houses white, deep-

eaved, pierced with small square windows at effective distances, and crossed with balconies, and above, a grove of ash or sycamore or both, sprayed all one way like waterweed beds in a running stream, very English-looking.

—Beyond again, in the midst of a slope of meadow slightly pulled like an unsteady and swelling surface of water, some ashes growing in a beautifully clustered 'bouquet.'



FIRST fine; then on the road a thunderstorm with hard rain, the thunder musical and like gongs and rolling in great floors of sound.



IN the train I was noticing that strange rotten-woven cloud which shapes in leaf over leaf of wavy or eyebrow texture: it is like fine webs or gossamers held down by many invisible threads on the under sides against a wind which between these points kept blowing them up into bells. The curious rottenness about them reminds one of that dark green silken oozy seaweed with holes in it which lines and hangs from piers and slubbered wood in the sea.



. . . the moon outside was roughing the lake with silver and dinting and tooling it with sparkling holes.



DAY bright. Sea calm, with little walking wavelets

edged with fine eyebrow crispings, and later nothing but a netting or chain-work on the surface, and even that went, so that the smoothness was marbly and perfect and, between the just-corded near sides of the waves rising like fishes' backs and breaking with darker blue the pale blue of the general field, in the very sleek hollows came out golden crumbs of reflections from the chalk cliffs.—Peach-coloured sundown and above some simple gilded messes of cloud, which later became finer, smaller, and scattering all away.—Here the sunlight had been dim.



I SAW the phenomenon of the sheepflock on the downs again from Croham Hurst. It ran like the water-packets on a leaf—that collectively, but a number of globules so filmed over that they would not flush together is the exacter comparison: at a gap in the hedge they were huddled and shaking open as they passed outwards they behaved as the drops would do (or a handful of shot) in reaching the brow of a rising and running over.



ANOTHER day in the evening after Litanies as Father Rector was giving the points for meditation I shut my eyes, being very tired, and without ceasing to hear him began to dream. The dream-images seemed to rise and overlies those which belonged to what he was saying and I saw one of the Apostles—he was talking about the Apostles—as if pressed against a piece of wood about half a yard long and a few inches

across, like a long box with two of the long sides cut off. Even then I could not understand what the piece of wood did encumbering the apostle. Now this piece of wood I had often seen in an outhouse and being that week 'A Secretis' I had seen it longer together and had been that day wondering what it was: in reality it is used to hold a little heap of cinders against the wall which keep from the frost a piece of earthenware pipe which there comes out and goes in again making a projection in the wall. It is just the things which produce dead impressions, which the mind, either because you cannot make them out or because they were perceived across other more engrossing thoughts, has made nothing of and brought into no scaping, that force themselves up in this way afterwards.—It seems true what Ed. Bond said, that you can trace your dreams to something or other in your waking life, especially of things that have been lately—I would not say this universally however. But the connection may be capricious, almost punning: I remember in one case to have detected a real pun but what it was I forget.

The dream-images also appear to have little or no projection, to be flat like pictures, and often one seems to be holding one's eyes close to them—I mean even while dreaming. This probably due to a difference still felt between images brought by ordinary use of function of sight and those seen as these are 'between our eyelids and our eyes'—though this is not all, for we also see the colours, brothy motes and figures, and at all events the positive darkness, made by the shut eyelids by the ordinary use of the

function of sight, but these images are brought upon that dark field, as I imagine, by a reverse action of the visual nerves (the same will hold of the sounds, sensations of touch, etc. of dreams)—or by other nerves, but it seems reasonable to suppose impressions of sight belong to the organ of sight—and once lodged there are stalled by the mind like other images: only you cannot make them at will when awake, for the very effort and advertence would be destructive to them, since the eye in its sane waking office kens only impressions brought from without, that is to say either from beyond the body or from the body itself produced upon the dark field of the eyelids. Nevertheless I have seen in favourable moments the images brought from within lying there like others: if I am not mistaken they are coarser and simpler and something like the spectra made by bright things looked hard at. I can therefore believe what Chandler told E. B., that at waking he could see—which is a step beyond seeing them on the field of the eyelids—the images of his dream upon the wall of his room.

It is not in reality harder for the mind to have ken at the same time of what the eye sees and also of the belonging images of our thoughts without ever or almost ever confounding them than it is for it to multiply the pictures brought by the two eyes into one without ever or almost ever separating them.



. . . neither the weight nor the stress of sorrow, that is to say of the thing which should cause sorrow, by themselves move us or bring the tears as a sharp

knife does not cut for being pressed as long as it is pressed without any shaking of the hand but there is always one touch, something striking sideways and unlooked for, which in both cases undoes resistance and pierces, and this may be so delicate that the pathos seems to have gone directly to the body and cleared the understanding in its passage. On the other hand the pathetic touch by itself, as in dramatic pathos, will only draw slight tears if its matter is not important or not of import to us, the strong emotion coming from a force which was gathered before it was discharged: in this way a knife may pierce the flesh which it had happened only to graze and only grazing will go no deeper.



IN the Park in the afternoon the wind was driving little clouds of snow-dust which caught the sun as they rose and delightfully took the eyes: flying up the slopes they looked like breaks of sunlight fallen through ravelled cloud upon the hills and again like deep flossy velvet blown to the root by breath which passed all along, Nearer at hand along the road it was gliding over the ground in white wisps that between trailing and flying shifted and wimpled like so many silvery worms to and from one another.



THE next morning a heavy fall of snow. It tufted and toed the firs and yews and went on to load them till they were taxed beyond their spring. The limes, elms, and Turkey-oaks it crisped beautifully as with young

leaf. Looking at the elms from underneath you saw every wave in every twig (become by this the wire-like stem to a finger of snow) and to the hangers and flying sprays it restored, to the eye, the inscapes they had lost. They were beautifully brought out against the sky, which was on one side dead blue, on the other washed with gold.



HAILSTONES are shaped like the cut of diamonds called brilliants.—I found one morning the ground in one corner of the garden full of small pieces of potsherd from which there rose up (and not dropped off) long icicles carried on in some way each like a forepitch of the shape of the piece of potsherd it grew on, like a tooth to its root for instance, and most of them bended over and curled like so many tusks or horns or / best of all and what they looked likest when they first caught my eye / the first soft root-spurs thrown out from a sprouting chestnut. This bending of the icicle seemed so far as I could see not merely a resultant, where the smaller spars of which it was made were still straight, but to have flushed them too.—The same day and others the garden mould very crisp and meshed over with a lace-work of needles leaving (they seemed) three-cornered openings: it looked greyish and like a coat of gum on wood. Also the smaller crumbs and clods were lifted fairly up from the ground on upright ice-pillars, whether they had dropped these from themselves or drawn them from the soil: it was like a little Stonehenge.—Looking down into the thick ice of our pond I found the im-

prisoned air-bubbles nothing at random but starting from centres and in particular one most beautifully regular white brush of them, each spur of it a curving string of beaded and diminishing bubbles.—The pond, I suppose from over pressure when it was less firm, was mapped with a puzzle of very slight clefts branched with little sprigs: the pieces were odd-shaped and sized—though a square angular scaping could be just made out in the outline but the cracks ran deep down through the ice markedly in planes and always the planes of the cleft on the surface. They remained and in the end the ice broke up in just these pieces.



‘THE young lambs bound As to the tabour’s sound.’ They toss and toss: it is as if it were the earth that flung them, not themselves. It is the pitch of graceful agility when we think that.—Sometimes they rest a little space on the hind legs and the forefeet drop curling in on the breast, not so liquidly as we see it in the limbs of foals though.



BUT such a lovely damasking in the sky as today I never felt before. The blue was charged with simple instress, the higher, zenith sky earnest and frowning, lower more light and sweet. High up again, breathing through woolly coats of cloud or on the quains and branches of the flying pieces it was the true exchange of crimson, nearer the earth / against the sun / it was turquoise, and in the opposite south-western bay

below the sun it was like clear oil but just as full of colour, shaken over with slanted flashing 'travellers,' all in flight, stepping one behind the other, their edges tossed with bright ravelling, as if white napkins were thrown up in the sun but not quite at the same moment so that they were all in a scale down the air falling one after the other to the ground.



JUST caught sight of a little whirlwind which ran very fast careering across our pond. It was made by conspiring catspaws seeming to be caught in, in a whorl, to the centre. There were of course two motions, the travelling and the rotation. The circle was regular. . . . Each tail of catspaw seemed to fling itself alive into its place in turn. . . . I saw that there was something eery, Circe-like and quick about it.



THE banks are 'versed' with primroses, partly scattered, partly in plots and squats, and at a little distance shewing milkwhite or silver—little spilt till-fulls of silver. I have seen them reflected in green standing farmyard water.



I HAVE several times seen the peacock with train spread lately. It has a very regular warp, like a shell, in which the bird embays himself, the bulge being inwards below but the hollow inwards above, cooping him in and only opening towards the brim, where the feathers are beginning to rive apart. The eyes, which

lie alternately when the train is shut, like scales or gadroons, fall into irregular rows when it is opened, and then it thins and darkens against the light, it loses the moistness and satin it has when in the pack but takes another / grave and expressive splendour, and the outermost eyes, detached and singled, give with their corner fringes the suggestion of that inscape of the flowing cusped trefoil which is often effective in art. He shivers it when he first rears it and then again at intervals and when this happens the rest blurs and the eyes start forward.—I have thought it looks like a tray or green basket or fresh-cut willow hurdle set all over with Paradise fruits cut through—first through a beard of golden fibre and then through wet flesh greener than green-gages or purpler than grapes—or say that the knife had caught a tatter or flag of the skin and laid it flat across the flesh—and then within all a sluggish corner drop of black or purple oil.



IT was a glowing yellow sunset. Pendle and all the hills rinsed clear, their heights drawn with a brimming light, in which windows or anything that could catch fluttered and laughed with the blaze—all bounded by the taught outline of a mealy blue shadow covering the valley, which was moist and giving up mist. Now where a strong shadow lay in a slack between two brows of Pendle appeared above the hill the same phenomenon I had seen twice before (once near Brussels), a wedge of light faintly edged, green on the right side, red on the left, as a rainbow would

be, leaning to the right and skirting the brow of the hill with a glowing edge. It lasted as long as I looked without change—I do not know how long but between five minutes and a quarter of an hour perhaps. It had clouds it seemed to me *behind* it. Later when it was growing dark and the glow of the sunset was quite gone I noticed to the right of the spot a little—over Whalley—a rack of red cloud floating away, the red being I am persuaded a native colour, in fact it could not have been borrowed, the sun having long set and the higher clouds behind it not having it.



THE Horned Violet is a pretty thing, gracefully lashed. Even in withering the flower ran through beautiful inscapes by the screwing up of the petals into straight little barrels or tubes. It is not that inscape does not govern the behaviour of things in slack and decay as one can see even in the pining of the skin in the old and even in a skeleton but that horror prepossesses the mind, but in this case there was nothing in itself to shew even whether the flower were shutting or opening.



AFTER much rain, some thunder, and no summer as yet, the river swollen and golden and, where charged with air, like ropes and hills of melting candy, there was this day a thunderstorm on a greater scale—huge rocky clouds lit with livid light, hail and rain that flooded the garden, and thunder ringing and echoing round like brass, so that there is in a man-

ner earwitness to the χαλκεον ούρανόν. The lightning seemed to me white like a flash from a lookingglass but Mr. Lentaigne in the afternoon noticed it rose-coloured and lilac. I noticed two kinds of flash but I am not sure that sometimes there were not the two together from different points of the same cloud or starting from the same point different ways—one a straight stroke, broad like a stroke with chalk and liquid, as if the blade of an oar just stripped open a ribbon scar in smooth water and it caught the light; the other narrow and wire-like, like the splitting of a rock and danced down-along in a thousand jags. I noticed this too, that there was a perceptible interval between the blaze and first inset of the flash and its score in the sky and that that seemed to be first of all laid in a bright confusion and then uttered by a tongue of brightness (what is strange) running up from the ground to the cloud, not the other way.



IN returning the sky in the west was in a great wide winged or shelved rack of rice-white fine pelleted fretting. At sunset it gathered downwards and as the light then bathed it from below the fine ribbings and long brindled jetties dripping with fiery bronze had the look of being smeared by some blade which had a little flattened and richly mulled what it was drawn across. This bronze changed of course to crimson and the whole upper sky being now plotted with pale soaked blue rosetting seized some of it foreward in wisps or plucks of smooth beautiful carnation or of coral or camellia / rosecolour.

A LUNAR halo: I looked at it from the upstairs library window. It was a grave grained sky, the strands rising a little from left to right. The halo was not quite round, for in the first place it was a little pulled and drawn below, by the refraction of the lower air perhaps, but what is more it fell in on the nether left hand side to rhyme the moon itself, which was not quite at full. I could not but strongly feel in my fancy the odd instress of this, the moon leaning on her side, as if fallen back, in the cheerful light floor within the ring, after with magical rightness and success tracing round her the ring the steady copy of her own outline. But this sober grey darkness and pale light was happily broken through by the orange of the pealing of Mitton bells.



SAW a lad burning big bundles of dry honeysuckle: the flame (though it is no longer freshly in my mind) was brown and gold, brighter and glossier than glass or silk or water and ran reeling up to the right in one long handkerchief and curling like a cartwhip.



WE have a cherry tree from head to foot every branch sleeved with white glossy blossom.



WHEN the sunlight near sunset falls on the wall of my room I can see the fuming of the atmosphere marked like the shadow of smoke: I have seen it once with the light coming through leaves, and this

got less and less distinct on white paper which I moved towards the window, and once coming without a break from the brim of the fells. It is the same seen the other way as the watery riot one sees in the sun's disc when low.



THE country is bare and you see the valleys and fell-sides plotted and painted with the squares of the fields and their hedges far and wide. But the trees are rich and thickly leaved where they grow. I remember one little square house cushioned up in a thatched grove of green like a man with an earache.



. . . that ridge ruddy with fern and evening light.



UNDER a dark sky walking by the river at Brockennook. There all was sad-coloured and the colour caught the eye, red and blue stones in the river beaches brought out by patches of white-blue snow, that is / snow quite white and dead but yet it seems as if some blue or lilac screen masked it somewhere between it and the eye: I have often noticed it. . . . Where the snow lies as in a field the damasking of white light and silvery shade may be watched indeed till brightness and glare is all lost in a perplexity of shadow and in the whitest of things the sense of white is lost, but at a shorter gaze I see two degrees in it—the darker, facing the sky, and the lighter in the tiny cliffs or scarps where the snow is broken

or raised into ridges, these catching the sun perhaps or at all events more directly hitting the eye and gilded with an arch brightness, like the sweat in the moist hollow between the eyebrows and the eyelids on a hot day or in the way the light of a taper Tommy was screening with his hand the other morning in the dark refectory struck out the same shells of the eyes and the cleft of the nostrils and flat of the chin and tufts on the cheeks in gay leaves of gold.



IN the snow flat-topped hillocks and shoulders outlined with wavy edges, ridge below ridge, very like the grain of wood in line and in projection like relief maps. These the wind makes I think and of course drifts, which are in fact snow waves. The sharp nape of a drift is sometimes broken by slant flutes or channels. I think this must be when the wind after shaping the drift first has changed and cast waves in the body of the wave itself. All the world is full of inscape and chance left free to act falls into an order as well as purpose: looking out of my window I caught it in the random clods and broken heaps of snow made by the cast of a broom. The same of the path trenched by footsteps in ankledeep snow across the fields leading to Hodder wood through which we went to see the river. The sun was bright, the broken brambles and all boughs and banks limed and cloyed with white, the brook down the clough pulling its way by drops and by bubbles in turn under a shell of ice.



UNDER a stone hedge was a dying ram: there ran slowly from his nostril a thick flesh-coloured ooze, scarlet in places, coiling and roping its way down, so thick that it looked like fat.



I LOOKED at the pigeons down in the kitchen yard and so on. They look like little gay juds by shape when they walk, strutting and jod-jodding with their heads. The two young ones are all white and the pins of the folded wings, quill pleated over quill, are like crisp and shapely cuttleshells found on the shore. The others are dull thundercolour or black-grape-colour except in the white pieings, the quills and tail, and in the shot of the neck. I saw one up on the eaves of the roof: as it moved its head a crush of satin green came and went, a wet or soft flaming of the light.



SOMETIMES I hear the cuckoo with wonderful clear and plump and fluty notes: it is when the hollow of a rising ground conceives them and palms them up and throws them out, like blowing into a big humming ewer. . . .



BRIGHT, with a high wind blowing the crests of the trees before the sun and fetching in the blaze and dousing it again. In particular there was one light raft of beech which the wind footed and strained on, ruffling the leaves which came out in their triplets threaded round with a bright brim like an edge of

white ice, the sun sitting at one end of the branch in a pash of soap-sud-coloured gummy bimbeams rowing over the leaves but sometimes flaring out so as to let a blue crust or platter from quite the quick of the orb sail in the eye.



WATER high at Hodder Roughs; where lit from within looking like pale gold, elsewhere velvety brown like ginger syrop; heavy locks or brushes like shaggy rope-ends rolling from a corner of the falls and one huddling over another; below the rock the bubble-jestled skirt of foam jumping back against the fall, which cuts its way clean and will not let it through, and there spitting up in long white ragged shots and bushes like a mess of thongs of bramble, and I saw by looking over nearer that those looping water-sprigs that lace and dance and jockey in the air are strung of single drops, the end one, like a tassel or a heavier bead, the biggest; they look like bubbles in a quill. When the air caught at the sill of the fall a sour yellow light flushed underneath like smoke kindling all along the rock, with a sullen noise which we thought was thunder till someone pointed out the cause, and this happened, I noticed, when one of the bladders or blisters that form and come bumping to the top in troubled water sailed over the falls.



VERY hot, though the wind, which was south, dappled very sweetly on one's face and when I came out

I seemed to put it on like a gown as a man puts on the shadow he walks into and hoods or hats himself with the shelter of a roof, a penthouse, or a copse of trees, I mean it rippled and fluttered like light linen, one could feel the folds and braids of it—and indeed a floating flag is like wind visible and what weeds are in a current; it gives it thew and fires it and bloods it in.



AT the end of the month hard frosts. Wonderful downpour of leaf: when the morning sun began to melt the frost they fell at one touch and in a few minutes a whole tree was flung of them; they lay masking and papering the ground at the foot. Then the tree seems to be looking down on its cast self as blue sky on snow after a long fall, its losing, its doing.



I SAW how delicately beautiful the orchards look from far above: the wrought-over boughs of the appletrees made an embroidery and whole head and wood a soft tufting and discolouring which were melted by the distance and the rain.



THE sea striped with splintered purple cloud-shadows. I marked the bole, the burling and roundness of the world. I sat down in the lap or fold of a steep slanting pasturefield the grass of which was so smooth and parched and light that it pained the eyes like a

road. . . . Many butterflies fluttering in the lanes, burnet-moths loafing on heads of scabious; hedges of white-thorn, and blackthorn thick with sloes, blackberries, flags in seed, tall yellow fennel starred with flowers etc.



WALKING with Wm. Splaine we saw a vast multitude of starlings making an unspeakable jangle. They would settle in a row of trees; then, one tree after another, rising at a signal they looked like a cloud of specks of black snuff or powder struck up from a brush or broom or shaken from a wig; then they would sweep round in whirlwinds—you could see the nearer and farther bow of the rings by the size and blackness; many would be in one phase at once, all narrow black flakes hurling round, then in another; then they would fall upon a field and so on.



I FIND myself both as man and as myself something most determined and distinctive, at pitch, more distinctive and higher pitched than anything else I see; I find myself with my pleasures and pains, my powers and my experiences, my deserts and guilt, my shame and sense of beauty, my dangers, hopes, fears, and all my fate, more important to myself than anything I see. And when I ask where does all this throng and stack of being, so rich, so distinctive, so important, come from / nothing I can see can answer me. And this whether I speak of human nature or of my individuality, my selfbeing. For human nature, being

more highly pitched, selved, and distinctive than anything in the world, can have been developed, evolved, condensed, from the vastness of the world not anyhow or by the working of common powers but only by one of finer or higher pitch and determination than itself and certainly than any that elsewhere we see, for this power had to force forward the starting or stubborn elements to the one pitch required. And this is much more true when we consider the mind; when I consider my selfbeing, my consciousness and feeling of myself, that taste of myself, of *I* and *me* above and in all things, which is more distinctive than the taste of ale or alum, more distinctive than the smell of walnutleaf or camphor, and is incommunicable by any means to another man (as when I was a child I used to ask myself: What must it be to be someone else?). Nothing else in nature comes near this unspeakable stress of pitch, distinctiveness, and selving, this selfbeing of my own. Nothing explains it or resembles it, except so far as this, that other men to themselves have the same feeling. But this only multiplies the phenomena to be explained so far as the cases are like and do resemble. But to me there is no resemblance: searching nature I taste *self* but at one tankard, that of my own being. The development, refinement, condensation of nothing shews any sign of being able to match this to me or give me another taste of it, a taste even resembling it.

One may dwell on this further. We say that any two things however unlike are in something like. This is the one exception: when I compare my self, my being-myself, with anything else whatever, all

things alike, all in the same degree, rebuff me with blank unlikeness; so that my knowledge of it, which is so intense, is from itself alone, they in no way help me to understand it. And even those things with which I in some sort identify myself, as my country or family, and those things which I own and call mine, as my clothes and so on, all presuppose the stricter sense of *self* and *me* and *mine* and are from that derivative.

